



Manohar Hotchandani,
Business Development Director,
Facebook.

Facebook Gaming's India progress

Facebook Gaming has huge plans for India and we get the details

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435 million people use Facebook in India every month and out of that 265 million people use Facebook on a daily basis. On a global level, over 900 million people either play games, watch gaming videos or engage in one of the hundreds of thousands of Facebook Groups. And in this last quarter, over one billion hours worth of gaming content was consumed on the platform. Suffice to say, gaming is a huge segment for Facebook and India offers a huge growth potential for gaming. With the recent Metaverse announcement, Facebook (now known as Meta) has only reinforced its intentions on building a unified gaming experience for its users. We got to have a chat with Manohar Hotchandani, Business Development Director, Facebook to gain a better understanding on how the platform is faring in India.

d One of the things we see in the US circuit is that quite a lot of Indie Game development studios tend to partner with platforms or streamers directly for publicity or to be part of a campaign. Likewise, do you have any initiative which would allow Indian Game Studios to reach out to you for something similar?

Manohar: We invite all developers, creators and ecosystem players to

come and work together with us. Logically, it's not just mentoring that we do but in some cases where we believe that they are very strong games or very strong concepts, we actually work with them to help them grow on the platform.

d We're not aware if there's any mechanism wherein fans can show support for their creators aside from subscriptions. And since Oct 1st, 2021, a lot of problems arose around recurring payment mechanisms. So is there something being worked on regarding that?

Manohar: We do have mechanisms in place. We call them 'Stars'. Each star is worth one cent and fans can potentially go and give stars to creators that they support. And we have payment mechanisms that either use UPI or Credit Cards to make that purchase happen.

d On most streams we can see that kids have developed the impression that if you cuss or dish out a lot of profanities on your stream, then you're likely to get better reach. Whereas most publishers that we've interacted with wish to see a more PG-13 environment being maintained across streams. Are there any efforts on that front?

Manohar: We do have some com-

munity guidelines which are strictly enforced in terms of all of those elements.

d At the onset, Microsoft's Mixer had tied up with several major streamers in the US to bring more traction to their platform. Are there any similar plans for Facebook Gaming in India?

Manohar: We welcome everyone. We welcome the larger creators, and we also welcome the nano and micro streamers to join our platform and make a living. We let them choose the method by which they wish to leverage the platform. There is livestreaming, Video on Demand and we're also experimenting with short format videos. We already have a lot of players working in the country already working with Facebook in some form of the other. And we democratise it in such a manner that helps them make the choice to figure out how they want to work with us.

d Does that also mean that there will be no exclusivity agreements?

Manohar: These are all conversations that, at that point in time, are business led and help determine what's good at that moment. All I'm saying is that from a user-perspective, we're giving a choice to the user to determine the format that they wish to participate on the platform. **d**